

• SECURITY ALERT

Your WordPress site could be taken over with zero login attempts.

A chained bug called wp2shell let attackers in with no username, no password, no warning.

WHAT HAPPENED

July 17, 2026: WordPress pushed an emergency patch.

Researchers nicknamed the exploit wp2shell — because that's exactly what it handed attackers: a shell on your server.

03/07

THE CHAIN

Two ordinary bugs. Combined, catastrophic.

A logic flaw in the REST API's batch endpoint (CVE-2026-63030) plus a SQL injection in core (CVE-2026-60137) let an attacker with no account run code on your site.

04/07

WHO'S EXPOSED

WordPress 6.8 through 7.0.1.

If a site you run — or manage for a client — sat on any of these versions in the weeks after July 17, this affected you.

05/07

THE FIX

Patched in 6.8.6, 6.9.5, and 7.0.2.

WordPress force-pushed this update through auto-update. That almost never happens — it means waiting for manual clicks wasn't fast enough.

Check these three things today:

- 01 Confirm your WordPress version in Dashboard › Updates
- 02 Update every plugin with a pending update
- 03 Open `/wp-content/mu-plugins/` and look for anything unfamiliar

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